Aga Khan University Examination Board

Notes from E-Marking Centre on SSC-I Pakistan Studies Examination May 2017

Introduction

This document has been produced for the teachers and candidates of Secondary School Certificate (SSC-I) Pakistan Studies. It contains comments on candidates' responses to the 2017 SSC-I Examination indicating the quality of the responses and highlighting their relative strengths and weaknesses.

E-Marking Notes

This includes overall comments on students' performance on every question and some specific examples of students' responses which support the mentioned comments. Please note that the descriptive comments represent an overall perception of the better and weaker responses as gathered from the e-marking session. However, the candidates' responses shared in this document represent some specific example(s) of the mentioned comments.

Teachers and candidates should be aware that examiners may ask questions that address the Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs) in a manner that require candidates to respond by integrating knowledge, understanding and application skills they have developed during the course of study. Candidates are advised to read and comprehend each question carefully before writing the response to fulfil the demand of the question.

Candidates need to be aware that the marks allocated to the questions are related to the answer space provided on the examination paper as a guide to the length of the required response. A longer response will not in itself lead to higher marks. Candidates need to be familiar with the command words in the Student Learning Outcomes which contain terms commonly used in examination questions. However, candidates should also be aware that not all questions will start with or contain one of the command words. Words such as 'how', 'why' or 'what' may also be used.

The paper of Pakistan Studies is generally divided into two main components i.e. history and geography. Candidates have attempted the geography portion relatively better than the history. The questions with a source either in history or geography were not comprehended well by the candidates and they were not able to score better in those questions. But in certain cases, it was a pleasure to read the well-articulated and contextualised answers.

Note: Student responses reproduced in this report have not been corrected for grammar, spelling, format or factual information.

Detailed Comments:

Constructed Response Questions (CRQs)

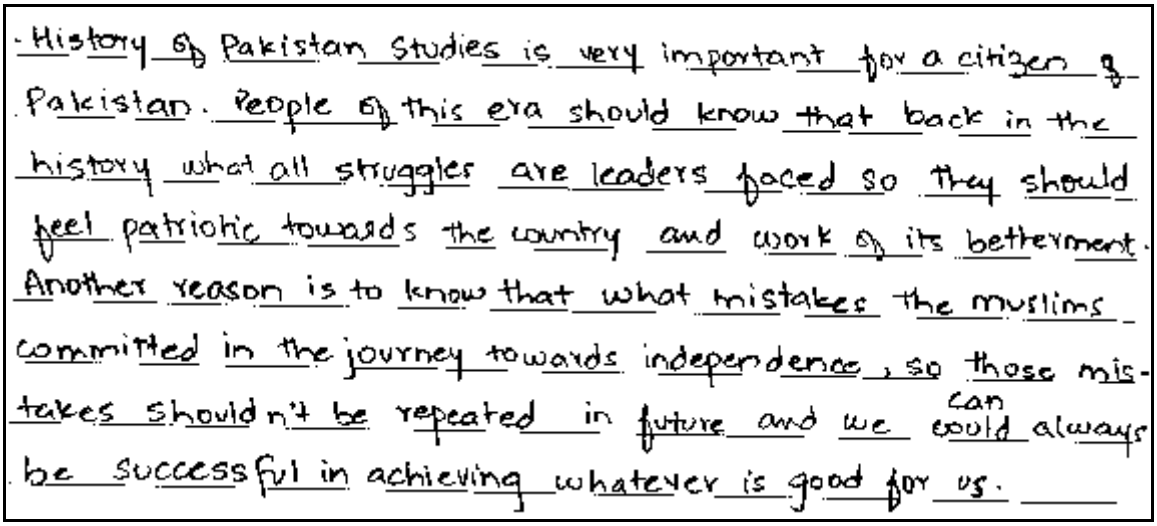
Question 1:

"If you don't know history, then you don't know anything. You are a leaf that doesn't know it is part of a tree. "
— Michael Crichton

In light of the given statement, describe any TWO reasons that show the importance of studying history in Pakistan Studies.

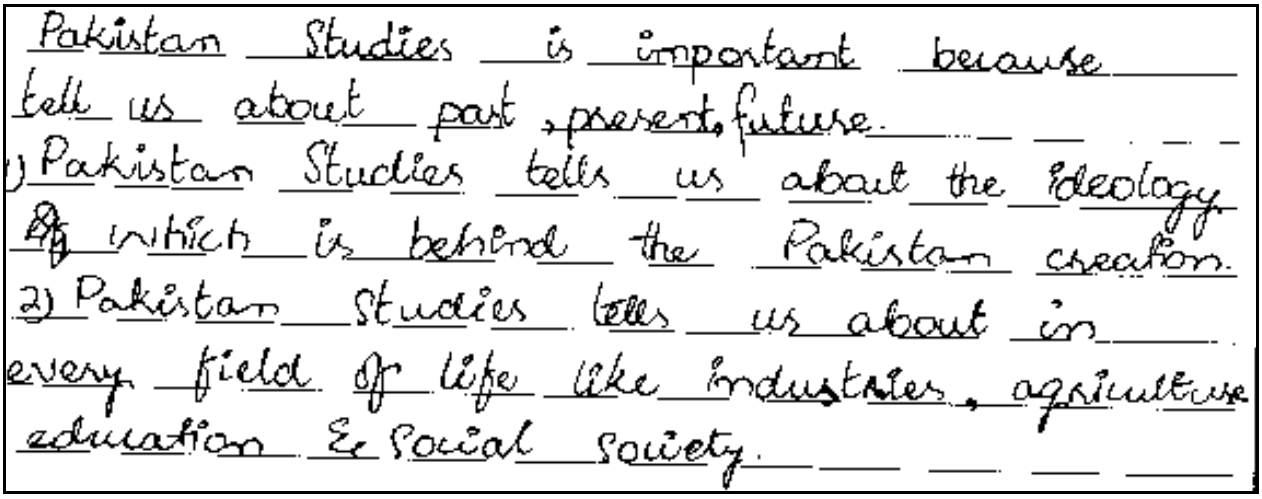
Better responses were able to understand the stimulus and mentioned the reasons for studying history accordingly. They included that it informs us about the sacrifices of our forefathers made due to which we are able to appreciate our independence as well as appreciate the struggle carried out by them; secondly, they mentioned that it teaches us about the mistakes of our forefathers so that we do not repeat them. Another point mentioned by the candidates was that through history we know about the foundation principles of our country or ideology and how can we, as citizens, uphold them to move our country towards progress.

Example:


History of Pakistan Studies is very important for a citizen of Pakistan. People of this era should know that back in the history what all struggles are leaders faced so they should feel patriotic towards the country and work of its betterment. Another reason is to know that what mistakes the muslims committed in the journey towards independence, so those mistakes shouldn't be repeated in future and we can could always be successful in achieving whatever is good for us.

Weaker responses were the ones in which the candidates either merely mentioned the given quote again in the answer or were not able to comprehend the quote at all and mentioned the importance of trees and general importance of studying History such as we know about the agricultural practices of our forefathers and we appreciate the growth of civilization from one civilization to another. Some responses only mentioned what it tells us but not why is it important to know it.

Example:

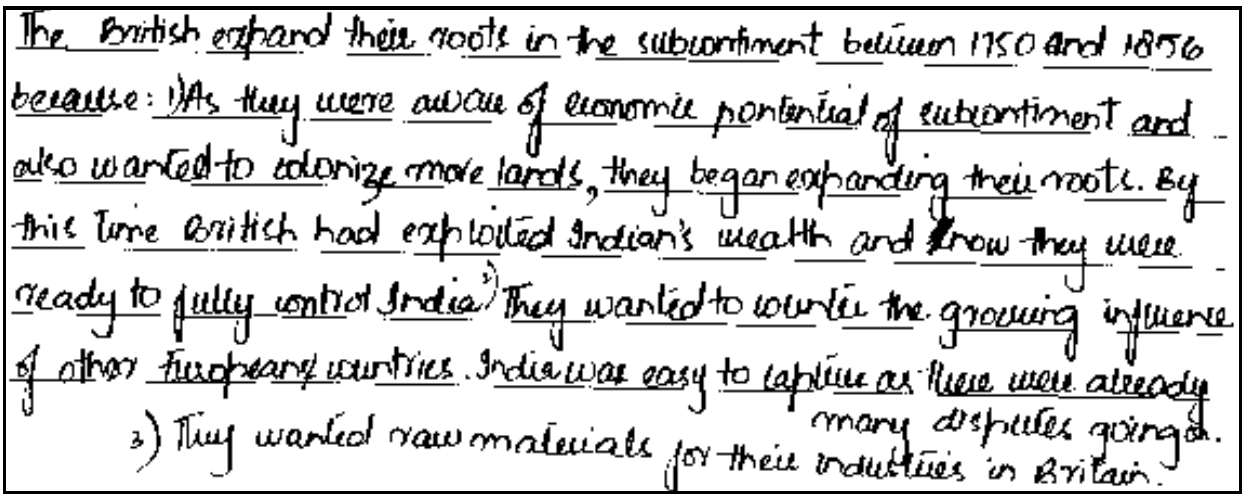

Pakistan Studies is important because tell us about past, present, future.
1) Pakistan Studies tells us about the Ideology which is behind the Pakistan creation.
2) Pakistan Studies tells us about in every field of life like industries, agriculture education & social society.

Question 2:

Why do you think the British expanded their roots in the subcontinent between 1750 and 1856? Give your answer in the context of socio-economic and political conditions of the subcontinent.

Better responses mentioned the reasons behind British expansion such as increased profit in trade; getting hold of fertile land; taking advantage of the weakness of the centralised government; re-establish their prestige and power in the region; using subcontinent as a market as well as supplier of raw material for British industries.

Example:


The British expand their roots in the subcontinent between 1750 and 1856 because: 1) As they were aware of economic potential of subcontinent and also wanted to colonize more lands, they began expanding their roots. By this time British had exploited Indian's wealth and know they were ready to fully control India. 2) They wanted to counter the growing influence of other European countries. India was easy to capture as there were already many disputes going on.
3) They wanted raw materials for their industries in Britain.

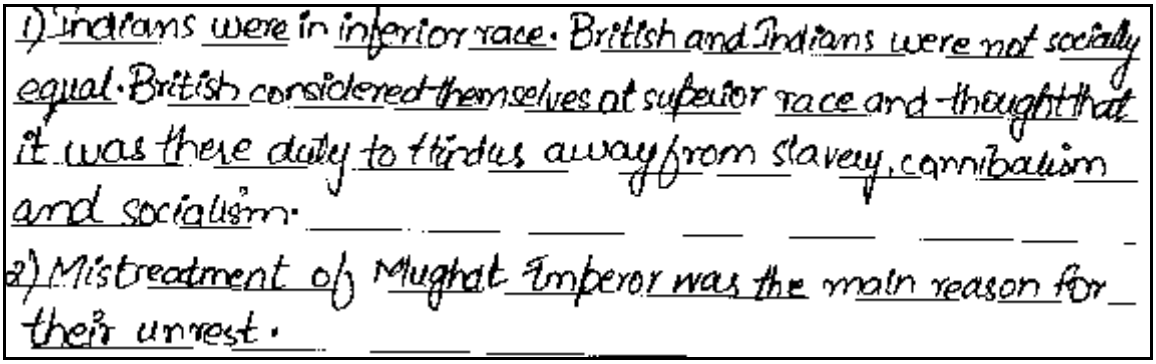
Weaker responses were the ones where the candidates did not comprehend the question and confused the reasons for expansion with any of the following:

a. Reasons of British coming to India such as trade, abundance of natural resources, less population, etc. with the reasons for expansion
b. Reasons that led to the War of Independence such as spread of Christianity, Indians to be employed as sepoys only, harsh treatment of Indians by the British, reforms introduced by the British.
c. Reasons that led to the downfall of the Mughal Empire

In some cases, candidates did mention the major wars such Plassey and Buxar but failed to give reasons behind the British success in those wars.

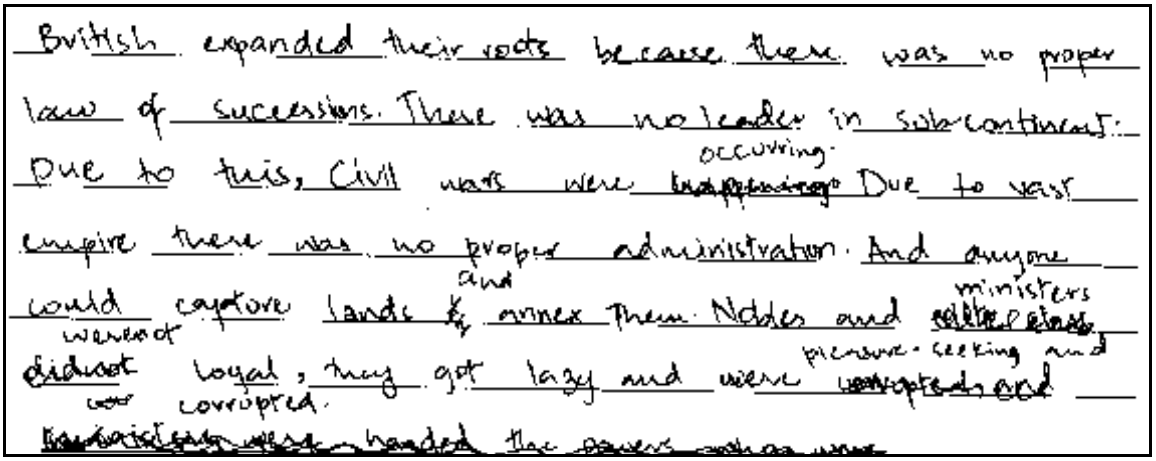
The weaker response also reflected the misunderstanding of the students regarding the expansion of British as they did not focus on the era mentioned in the question.

Example 1:


1) Indians were in inferior race. British and Indians were not socially equal. British considered themselves at superior race and thought that it was there duty to Hindus away from slavery, cannibalism and socialism.

2) Mistreatment of Mughal Emperor was the main reason for their unrest.

Example 2:


British expanded their roots because there was no proper law of sucessions. There was no leader in subcontinent. Due to this, Civil wars were occurring. Due to vast empire there was no proper administration. And anyone could capture lands & annex them. Nobles and ministers were not loyal, they got lazy and were pressure seeking and didnot corrupted.

Question 3:

a. What was Simla Deputation 1906?

b. Complete the table by describing the importance of the demands of the Simla Deputation (1906) for the Muslims of the subcontinent.

Better responses were able to mention the key points related to the first part, i.e. Muslim delegation' meeting with Viceroy Lord Minto and presentation of Muslim demands. The candidates were also able to specify the importance of the demands as required in the question. This reflected their understanding of the event as well as the importance of the propositions made by the Muslim delegation.

Example A:

Simla Deputation was a delegation set out to meet the Lord Minto in Simla, under the presidentship of Sir Aga Khan, to present Muslim demands to the British.

Example B:

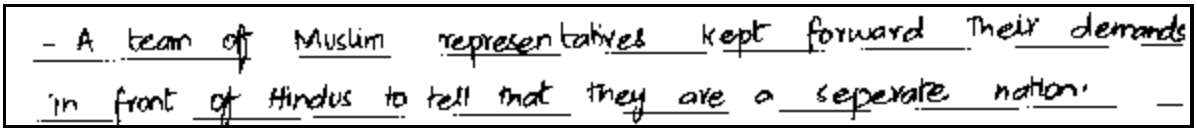
Demands put forward at Simla Deputation 1906	Importance for the Muslims of the Subcontinent
In all local and provincial elections, Muslims should have their own representatives, who would be elected only by Muslim voters.	Muslims should have a separate electorate and they could choose muslim representatives and can be identified as a nation.
In the councils, Muslims should have a higher percentage of seats than their percentage of the population.	Muslims can have representations in central assembly (central or local) and can demand for their rights and interests freely.

Weaker responses were able to mention a part of the key points but made mistakes in the name of the Viceroy or mentioned that it was an agreement. Some of the responses reflected confusion on part of candidates among Simla Deputation (1906), Simla Conference (1945) and Simla Accord (1971).

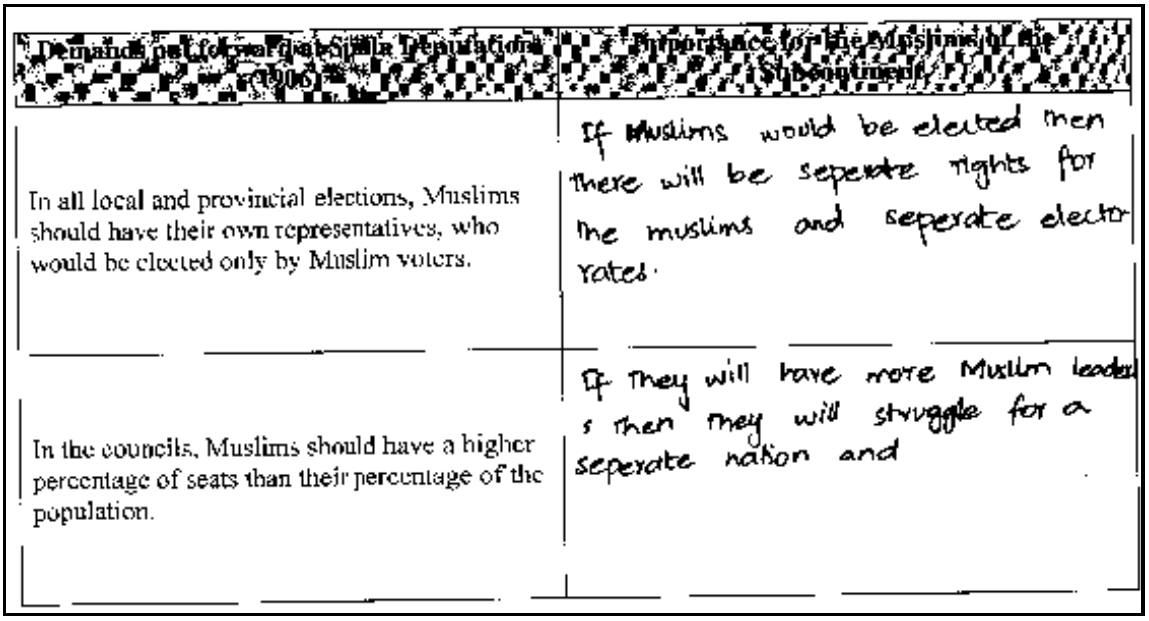
For the second part, they showed lack of understanding of the importance of the demands. The candidates either mentioned it incorrectly or mentioned the outcome of the Simla Deputation which was formation of Muslim League and grant of separate electorates for the Muslims, which was not asked in the question.

A major issue seen in this question was candidates knew the overall importance of Simla Deputation, they were not able to connect the importance with each demand of the Deputation.

Example A:



Example B:

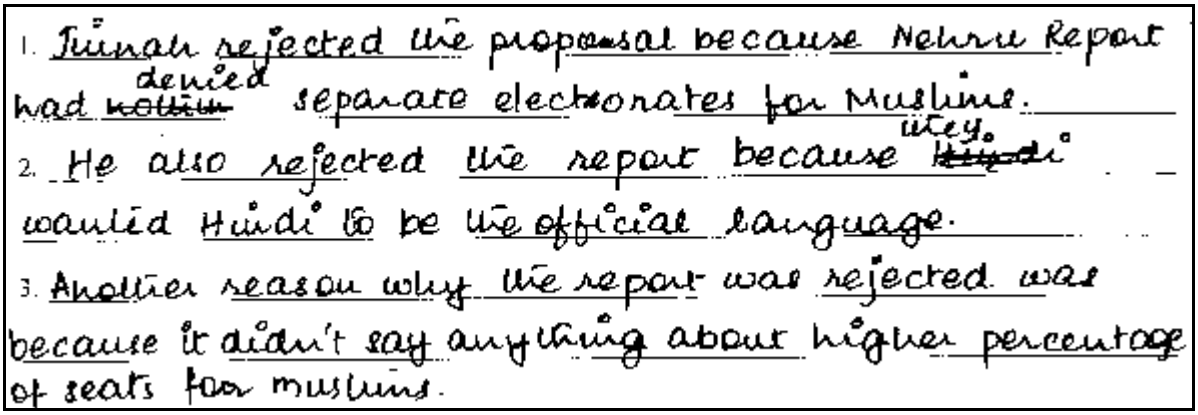


Question 4:

What were the bases on which Jinnah rejected the proposals of the Nehru Report (1928) and later came up with his own 14 Points (1929).

Better responses correctly mentioned Jinnah's critique of Nehru Report by identifying the points of the Nehru Report which disadvantaged the Muslims. This included that Nehru report had compromised the representation of the Muslims in the council which can disadvantage the Muslims of the subcontinent; secondly the importance towards Hindi language was also a threat towards the Urdu language which was the source of identity for the Muslims; also the right of separate electorate was curtailed which would make Muslim as non-existent minority in the subcontinent

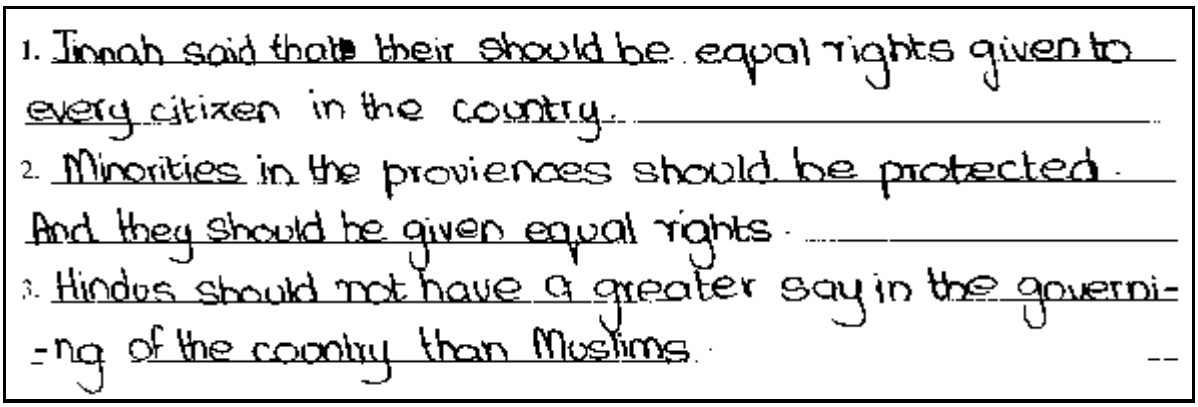
Example:


1. Jinnah rejected the proposal because Nehru Report had ~~notion~~ denied separate electorates for Muslims.
2. He also rejected the report because they. ~~Hindi~~ would Hindi be the official language.
3. Another reason why the report was rejected was because it didn't say anything about higher percentage of seats for muslims.

Weaker responses displayed the misunderstanding on the part of the candidates as they mentioned the clauses from the Fourteen Points rather than the underlying reasons behind rejection of Nehru Report i.e. why did Jinnah not accept the Nehru Report? What were the clauses in the Nehru Report which made him not to accept it? The candidates actually mentioned the solution proposed by Jinnah but not the problem created by Nehru Report.

Some of the responses also mentioned the policies of Indian National Congress such as self-rule.

Example:


1. Jinnah said that their should be equal rights given to every citizen in the country.
2. Minorities in the proviences should be protected. And they should be given equal rights.
3. Hindus should not have a greater say in the governi-ng of the coonty than Muslims.

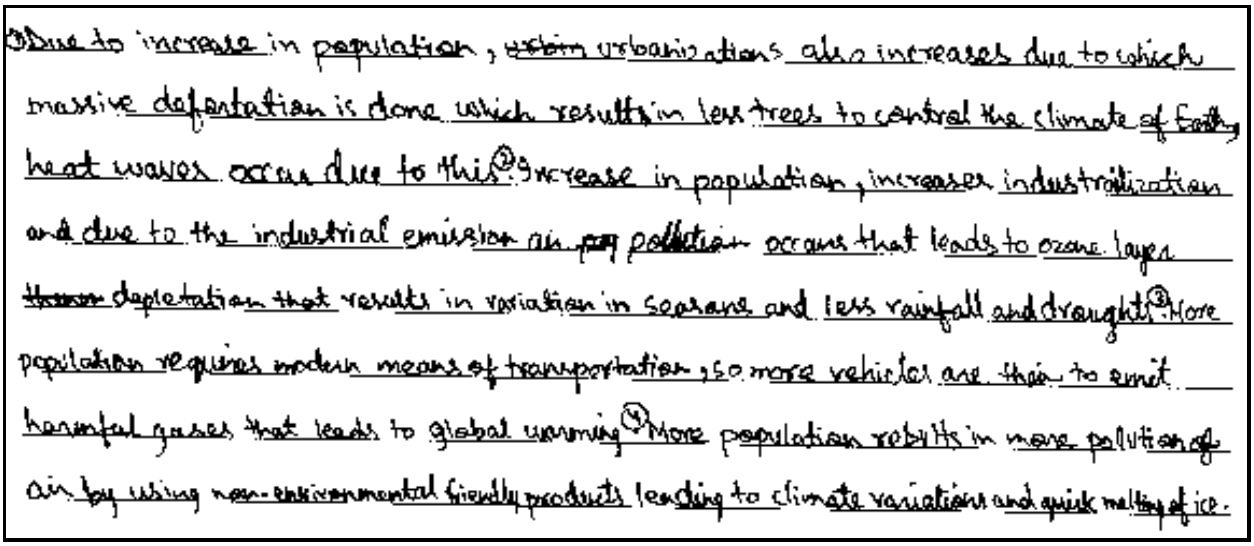
Question 5:

According to the United Nations Population Fund, human population grew from 1.6 billion to 6.1 billion people during the course of the 20th century.

Explain the impact of the given situation on the climate of Earth.

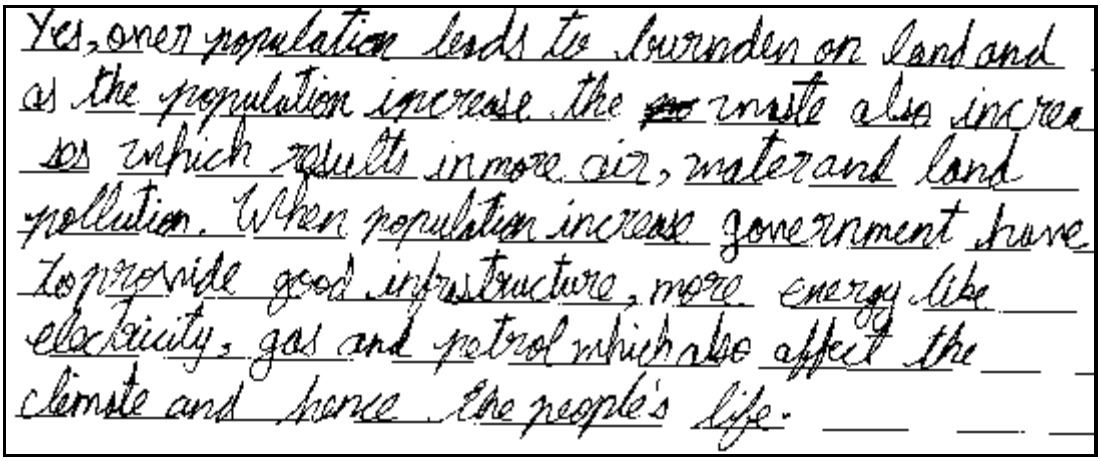
Better responses linked various human activities with their impact on the Earth which included that the cutting of trees has increased the quantity of carbon dioxide in the air resulting in greenhouse effect; deforestation leads to the lack of rainfall; industrialisation lead to water and air pollution which eventually leads to the depletion of ozone layer.

Example:



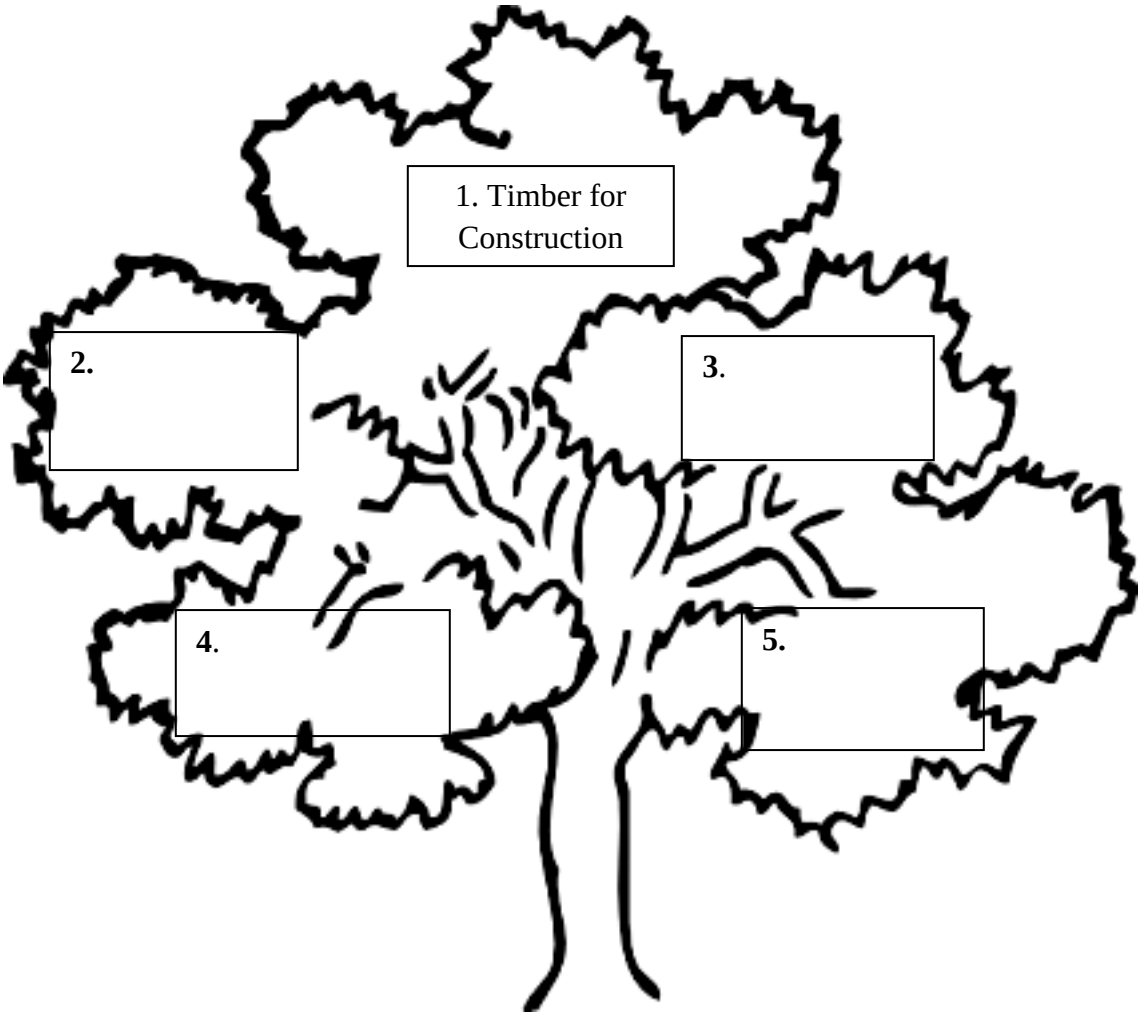
Weaker responses indicated that the candidates have not read the question carefully and instead of impact of overpopulation mentioned the causes of over population. Some of the responses did mention the impact but not on climate but on the socio-economic condition of the society. Some failed to link the human activity with the climate altogether. Another mistake the candidates made was that they only reflected on the stimulus and highlighted the working of the United Nations and how overpopulation would affect their work.

Example:


Yes, over population leads to lowrenden on land and as the population increase the ~~ere~~ waste also increases which results in more air, water and land pollution. When population increase government have to provide good infrastructure, more energy like electricity, gas and petrol which also affect the climate and hence the people's life.

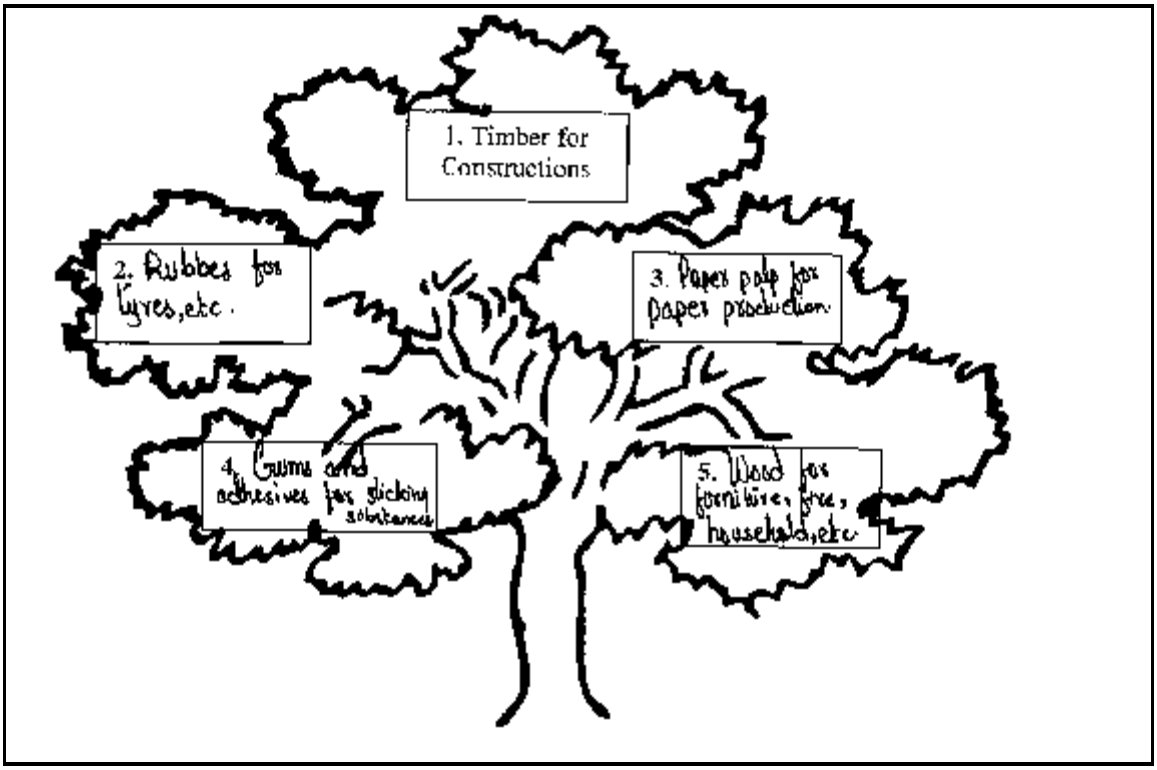
Question 6:

Forests are of two-fold importance: ecological and economic. Complete the given diagram with the economic importance of forests.



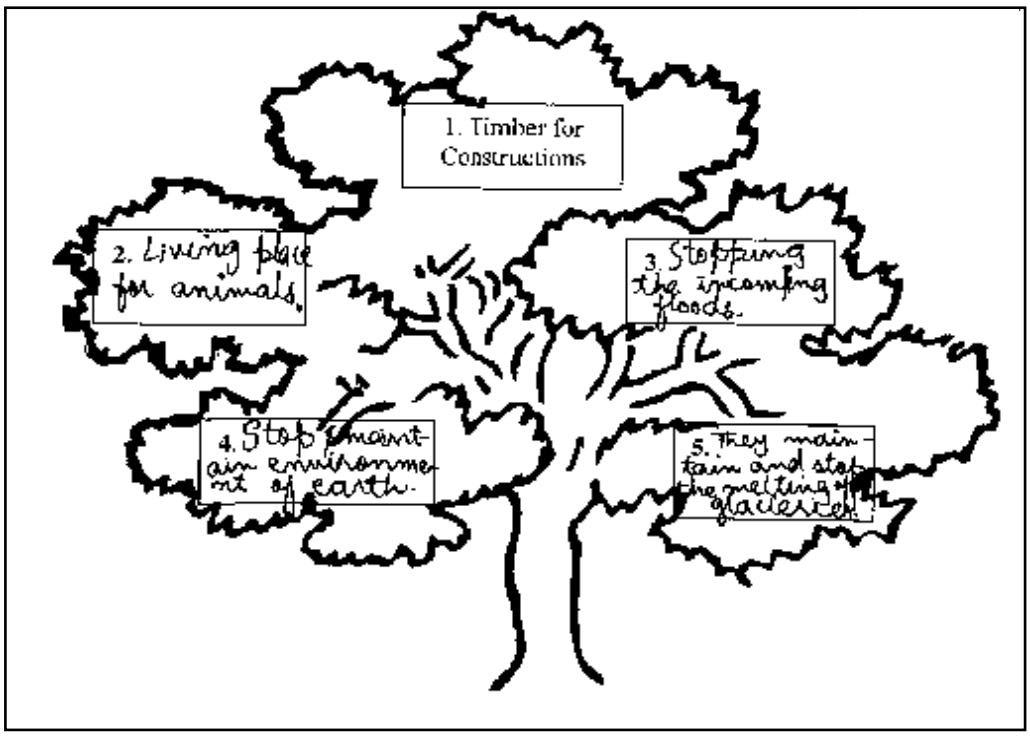
Better responses were those in which the candidates were able to comprehend the question and wrote about the economic importance of forests, e.g. raw material for wood based industries; supply of fruit; provide material for pharmaceutical industries; employment of people in forest-based industries; increase tourism in the area (recreational facilities), etc.

Example:



Weaker Responses highlighted that the candidates did not read the complete question and did not fulfil its requirement. Instead of mentioning the economic importance as specified in the question, they mentioned the ecological importance, e.g. that it balances the supply of oxygen; it regulates rainfall, etc.

Example:



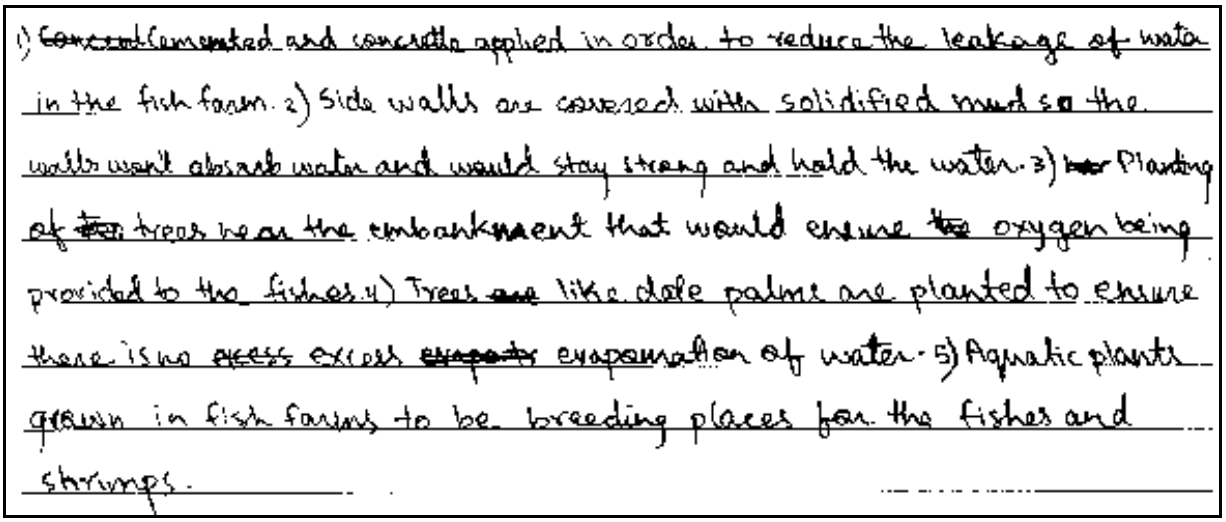
Question 7:

Fish farming involves raising fish commercially in tanks or enclosures, usually for human consumption.

Describe the factors that need to be kept in consideration while constructing fish farms.

Better responses mentioned the essential factors that need to be undertaken for the construction of fish farm such as supply of fresh water; provision of trees; cemented base to stop seepage; variety of fish; trained staff.

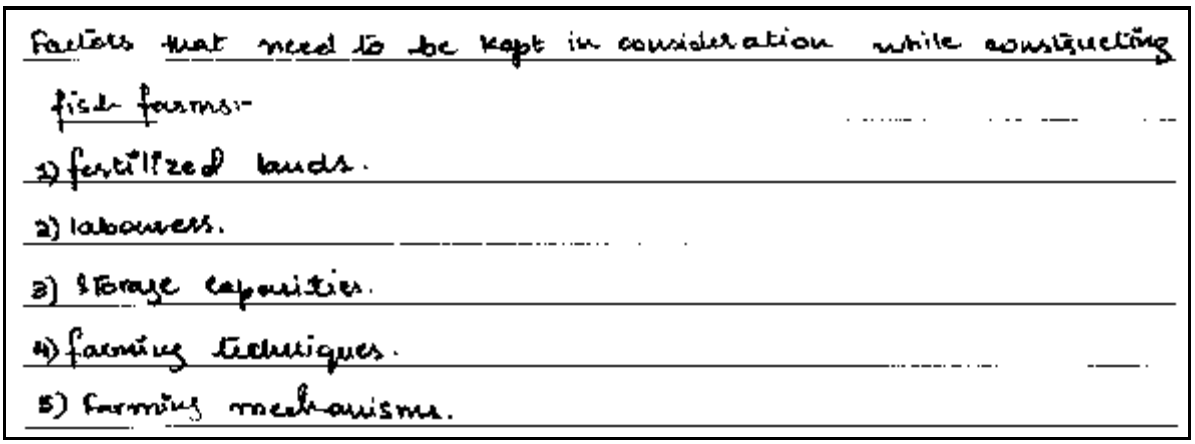
Example:



Weaker responses were the ones where the candidates were not able to give the factors asked but mentioned the importance of making fish farm, i.e. it will improve economy and bring in foreign exchange through its export.

Some candidates merely listed the considerations without any description.

Example:



Extended Response Questions (ERQs)

The following questions offer choice between part **"a"** and **"b"**

Question 8:

This was an ERQ (extended response question). This question offered a choice between Part **a** and **b**. Part **a** was a history based question whereas part **b** was based on human geography. Around 90% of the candidates attempted part **b** and only 10% attempted part **a**.

Part a:

Discuss any THREE socio-economic or political factors which contributed greatly to the formation of the Two Nation Theory in the subcontinent after the failure of the War of Independence (1857).

Better responses displayed good understanding of the topic and not only mentioned the appropriate reasons, but also discussed them by linking them to the formation of Two Nation Theory. These responses carried points such as prejudiced attitude of British towards the Muslims in terms of hiring them for jobs in administration and in army; Muslim merchants were disadvantaged in terms of running their business; Congress policies towards upholding Hindi as an official language; formation of All India National Congress.

Example:

a) Sir Syed put forward Two Nation Theory stating that Hindu and Muslims are two seperate nations, with seperate religion and culture, and so they should be treated different.

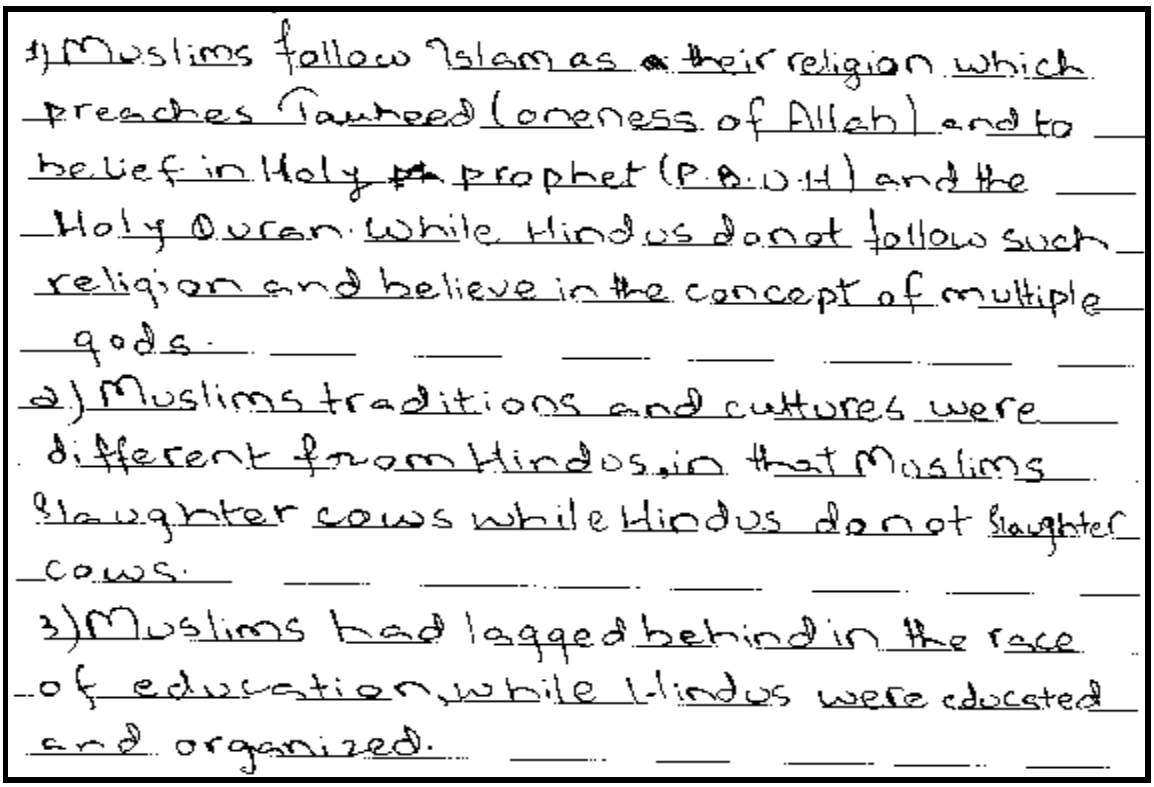
Reasons for Putting Forward Two Nation Theory:-

- Indian National Congress was made by Allan as a platform where Indians would state their problems but Sir Syed soon found out that the Congress only spoke about the Hindus
- They put forward the demand of Political Representation through democracy. The Hindus knew that they are in majority and would definitely win the elections and did not consider about minorities. Sir Syed pointed this out and refused to accept the demand.
- A demand for Competative Examination was made. Sir Syed refused this as well as the Hindus very well knew that the Muslims were not seeking Education on British line and would not pass the exams.
- Sir Syed saw how the Hindus fought during Hindi-Urdu controversy and how they think about Muslims and their culture.

These three points made Sir Syed realize that Hindus and Muslims are two seperate nations, as Hindus would not make any concessions to Muslims at any cost.

Weaker responses did not reflect on the demand of the question. Candidates mainly wrote about the causes of failure of Muslims in the War of Independence 1857 which included lack of unity and finances etc. Some responses defined the Two Nation Theory but did not mention or discuss the reasons behind its formation. Some responses did not focus on the time period and mentioned events way into 1900s. Some of the responses highlighted the contribution of Sir Syed Ahmed Khan towards the Muslims of the subcontinent.

Example 1:


1) Muslims follow Islam as their religion which preaches Tauheed (oneness of Allah) and to belief in Holy prophet (P.B.U.H) and the Holy Quran while Hindus do not follow such religion and believe in the concept of multiple gods.

2) Muslims traditions and cultures were different from Hindos, in that Muslims slaughter cows while Hindus do not slaughter cows.

3) Muslims had lagged behind in the race of education, while Hindus were educated and organized.

Example 2:

a. Two Nation Theory:

Two Nation theory ~~is~~ is two ~~country~~ Muslim and Hindu.

In Two Nation Theory Muslim and hindu seperated.

Allama Iqbal was aim Muslim is other country. and ~~Qa~~ Quaid-e-azam is seperated. Muslim and Hindu and Muslim is other country.

sir syed ahmad kham was a book "Now or Never"

Chudhry rehemat Ali Give a important role. He decide a name of pel pakistan. PAKISTAN. based on his city. e.g. punjab. Ichgbar pakhtu Ichawa etc.

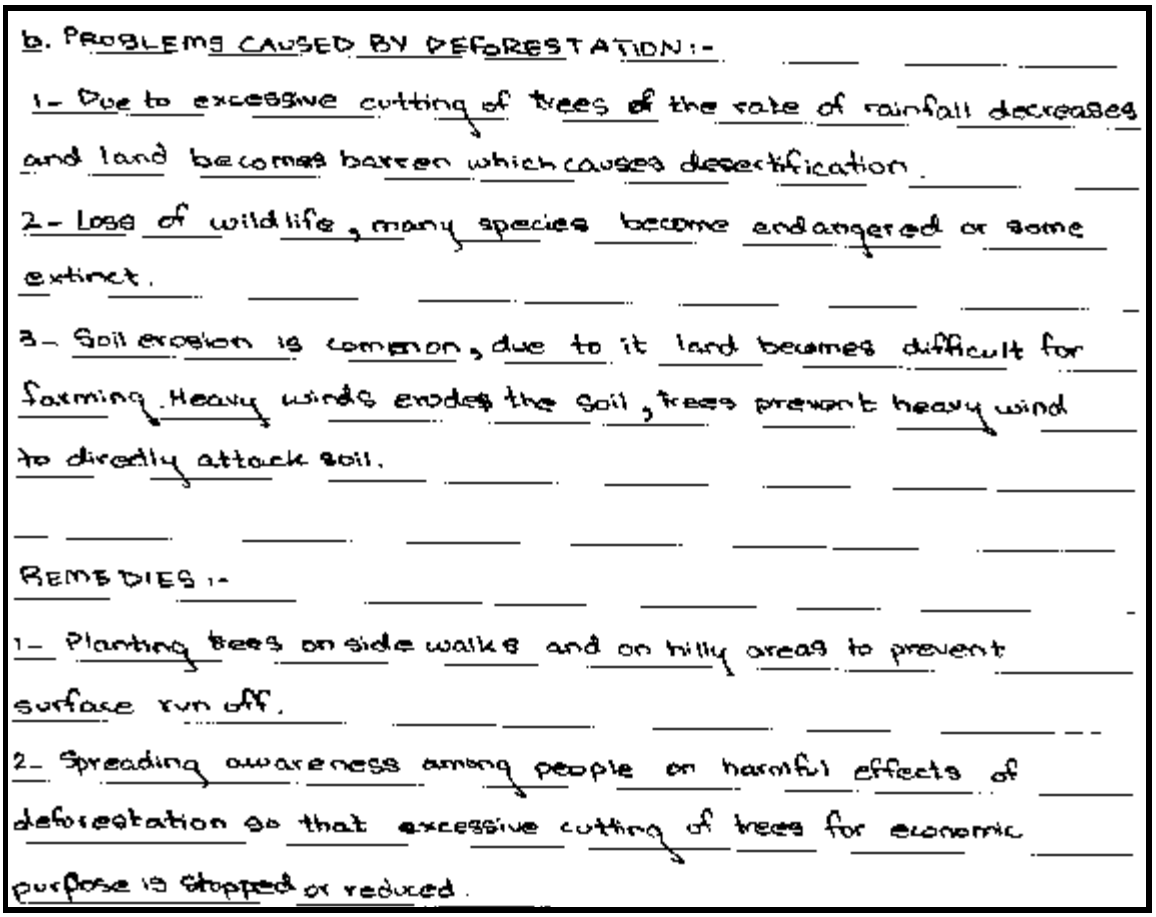
pakistan make in 14 August 1947. and ~~He~~ every ~~gear~~ celeberate this day.

Part b

Explain any THREE problems caused by deforestation and suggest any TWO remedies to overcome these problems.

Better responses discussed both, problem and solution. Candidates mentioned different problems that arise due to deforestation such as desertification; frequent flooding; climate imbalance; loss of habitat; soil erosion; shortage of fruits and were also able to give appropriate suggestions to overcome these problems such as awareness campaigns; reforestation programmes; provision of water to overcome desertification, etc.

Example:



b. PROBLEMS CAUSED BY DEFORESTATION :-

1- Due to excessive cutting of trees of the rate of rainfall decreases and land becomes barren which causes desertification.

2- Loss of wildlife, many species become endangered or some extinct.

3- Soil erosion is common, due to it land becomes difficult for farming. Heavy winds erodes the soil, trees prevent heavy wind to directly attack soil.

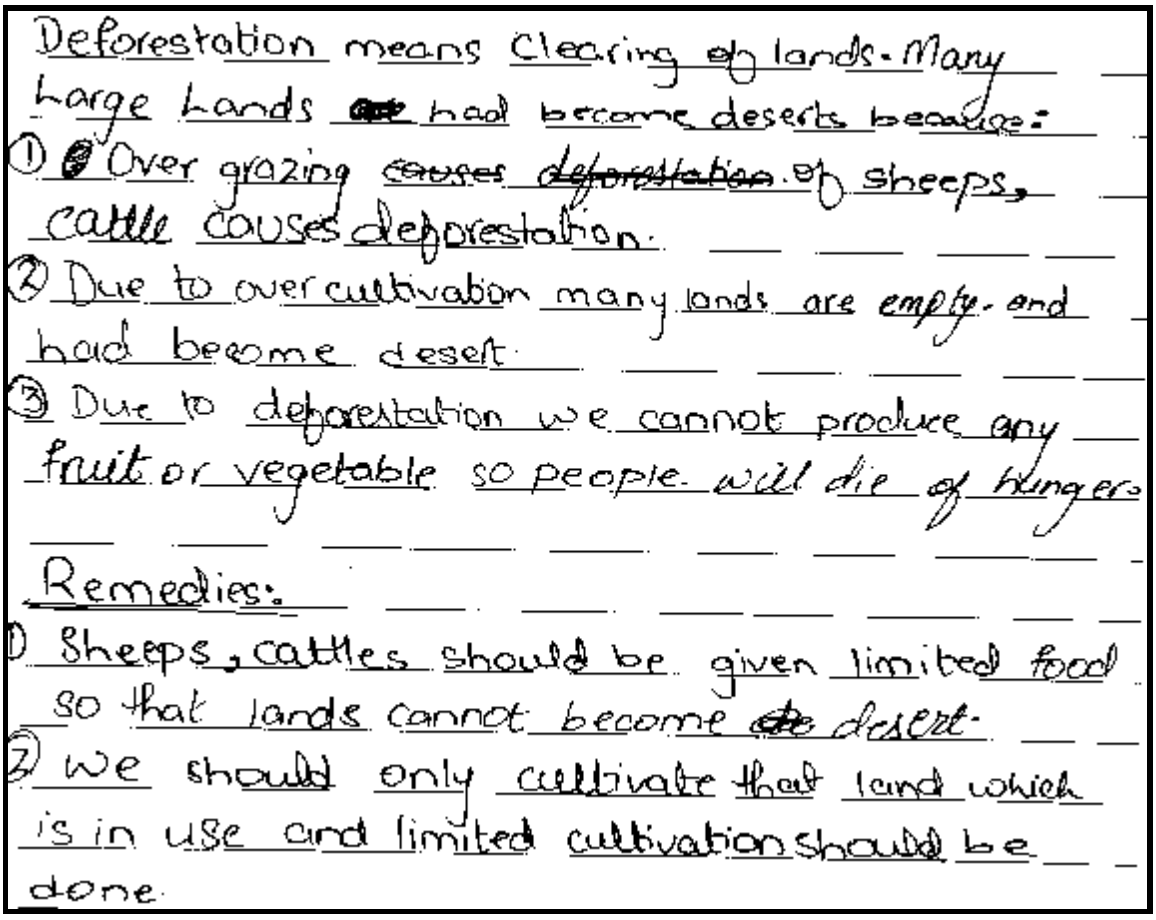
REMEDIES :-

1- Planting trees on side walks and on hilly areas to prevent surface run off.

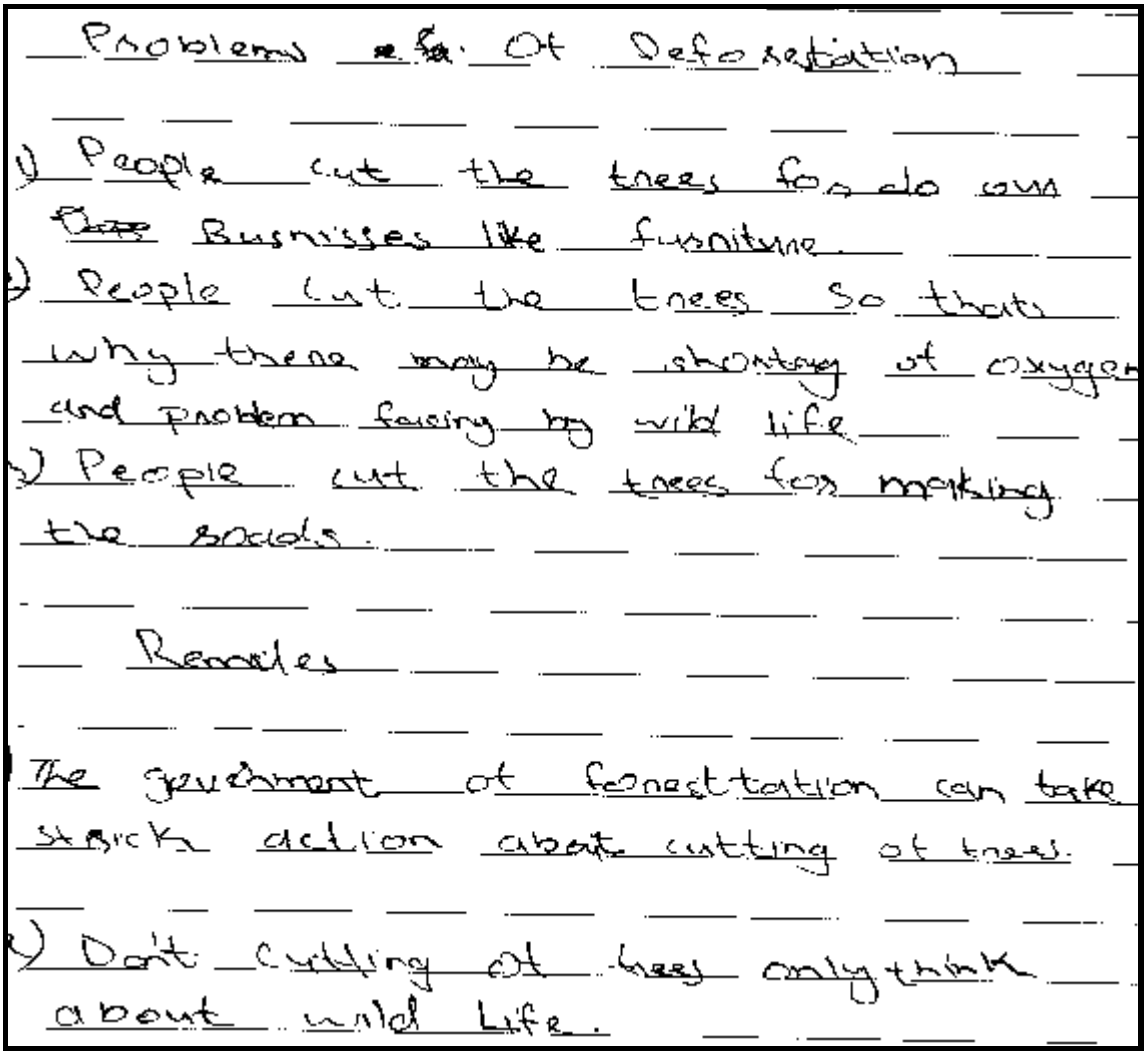
2- Spreading awareness among people on harmful effects of deforestation so that excessive cutting of trees for economic purpose is stopped or reduced.

Weaker responses, instead of discussing the problems caused by deforestation, mentioned the causes of deforestation. In the remedies, instead of mentioning suggestions to overcome the problems, they mentioned suggestions to stop deforestation. Some responses did write both problem and solution, but the solution was not about the problem mentioned by the candidates in the answers.

Example 1:


Deforestation means Clearing of lands. Many large Lands had become deserts because:
① Over grazing causes deforestation. of sheeps, cattle causes deforestation.
② Due to over cultivation many lands are empty. and had become deseft
③ Due to deforestation we cannot produce any fruit or vegetable so people will die of hungers
Remedies:
① Sheeps, cattles should be given limited food so that lands cannot become desert.
② we should only cultivate that land which is in use and limited cultivation should be done.

Example 2:



Problems of Deforestation

1) People cut the trees for also use Businesses like furniture.
2) People cut the trees so that why there may be shortage of oxygen and problem facing by wild life.
3) People cut the trees for making the roads.

Remedies

The government of forestation can take strick action about cutting of trees.

1) Don't cutting of trees only think about wild life.